

Angle Exploration & Creative Concepts

60 production-ready creative angles across 10 clusters. Each angle includes pain-point grounding, hooks, mechanism tie-in, and full production specifications. Built from customer complaint filings, owner-to-owner forum threads, review platforms, and peer-reviewed veterinary literature. Not from assumption, and not from competitor marketing copy.

How to use this document: Each angle card is a complete creative brief. An editor can produce from the visual and audio direction without asking a follow-up question. The strategist selects test order from the ICP × Pain Point matrix below. Compliance risk is flagged per angle so nothing reaches production without the constraint attached.

Sourcing standard. Hooks marked **FORUM** use language taken verbatim from what owners wrote to each other on dogforums.com, poodleforum.com and Quora. Hooks marked **BBB** derive from formal complaint filings. Every ecommerce brand blog in this category was excluded, including Spot & Tango, Ollie, Freshpet, Purina and The Farmer's Dog itself, because a brand's own content about its own category is marketing rather than evidence. Full source list in the DRIVE Research document.

Priority Matrix Process Truth The Refusal Price Permission The
Clock Starting Point Authority Displacement Identity Friction
Transition Raw VOC

ICP × Pain Point Priority Matrix

Scores 1-5 represent how intensely each ICP feels each pain point. **5** = this keeps them up at night. **1** = barely registers. Test the 5-rated cells first. Each one is a validated angle with the highest probability of resonance.

Pain Point	David Vet Visit	Rachel Picky Eater	Mia Researcher	Frank Senior Dog	Sam New Puppy	Nadia Price-Blocked
Fear I caused this	5	2	4	4	2	3
Dog refusing food	3	5	1	3	2	2
Costs more than my own food	2	3	3	2	3	5
Freezer space / storage	2	3	3	2	3	4
Dog slowing down with age	3	1	2	5	1	2

Doubt about processing	4	2	5	3	4	3
Overwhelmed by brand choice	4	4	4	3	5	3
Vet bill anxiety	5	2	2	4	3	3
Getting it right from day one	2	2	3	1	5	2
Guilt over years of kibble	5	2	4	5	1	2
Skeptical of marketing	3	3	5	3	3	4
Wasting money on refused food	2	5	1	2	2	4
Not knowing correct portions	3	3	3	2	5	2
Running out of time	4	1	2	5	1	2
Partner will think I am mad	2	2	2	2	3	5

Matrix Insights

- **Nadia carries three 5s and two 4s** across cost, partner judgement, wasted money, freezer, and skepticism. She is the

densest cluster of unaddressed intensity in the market, and she is already at checkout. Test her first.

- **“Overwhelmed by brand choice” scores 3-5 across every single ICP.** It is the only universal pain point on the board. A simplification angle works for everyone, which makes it the safest broad-audience test.
- **Guilt over years of kibble is a 5 for both David and Frank.** These two ICPs are emotionally adjacent and can often share creative with only the dog’s age changed. That is a cheap variation axis.
- **Rachel’s two 5s (refusal, wasted money) are the same moment** viewed from two angles: the bowl going in the bin. One asset serves both.
- **Freezer space never scores 5 but never drops below 2.** It is a broad low-grade drag rather than a sharp pain, which is exactly why it kills conversions quietly and never shows up in a survey.

Cluster 1: The Process Truth (7 Angles)

This cluster moves the argument from ingredients to processing. In a Stage 4 market where every brand claims human-grade, the ingredient list has stopped separating anyone. The process has not been claimed.

Angle 1.1: “The Label Is Telling the Truth”

Priority: Highest

ICP: Mia, David

Schwartz: Stage 4

LF8: Care + Superiority

The ingredient list describes what went into the machine. It does not describe what came out.

Core reframe, DRIVE Phase 2

Hooks:

1. “Your kibble’s ingredient list is completely honest. It is also answering the wrong question.”
2. “Real chicken, first ingredient. Then it went through an extruder at three hundred degrees.”
3. “You have been reading the label. You should have been reading the process.”
4. “Premium kibble and the cheap stuff go through the exact same machine.”

Mechanism tie-in: Extrusion grinds, mixes, and forces ingredients through a die under high heat and pressure. The label documents inputs. Gently cooked food skips that step entirely, so inputs and outputs stay closer together.

Format: Text-wall static, or 25–30 sec explainer video **Tone:** Calm, factual, slightly conspiratorial **Length:** Single image, or 25–30 sec **Visual:** Hand holding a premium kibble bag, finger tracing the ingredient list. Cut to industrial extruder footage. Cut back to the bag. Then the fresh food, unprocessed, in a pack. **Audio:** Measured voiceover, no music under the reveal **Compliance:** **Medium risk** — describe the process factually. Do not claim health harm. Do not name a manufacturer.

Angle 1.2: “Ultra-Processed, For Dogs”

Priority: Highest

ICP: Mia, Sam

Schwartz: Stage 4

LF8: Care of loved ones

Veterinary nutritionists have called for a Nova-style classification system for pet food, mirroring the framework used to classify ultra-processed food for humans.

Fi Global Insights, cited in Brand Intelligence Report

Hooks:

1. “You stopped buying ultra-processed food for yourself. Check what is in the bowl by the door.”
2. “Vets are now arguing about whether kibble should be classified the same way we classify human junk food.”
3. “You read labels for your family. When did you last read one for him?”

Mechanism tie-in: Borrows a frame the prospect already holds and applies it to a room they had not looked in. This does not teach a new belief. It extends an existing one, which is far cheaper.

Format: Carousel (4 slides) or text-wall static **Tone:** Informed, direct, not preachy **Length:** 4 slides **Visual:** Slide 1: a human ultra-processed snack aisle. Slide 2: a kibble aisle, shot identically. Slide 3: the classification question in plain type. Slide 4: the product. **Audio:** N/A (static)

Compliance: **High risk** — the classification debate is real and ongoing, but it is a debate. Frame as “researchers are asking”, never as settled science. Pull and read the primary papers before this runs.

Angle 1.3: “Two Bowls”

Priority: High

ICP: All

Schwartz: Stage 3-4

LF8: Care + Food enjoyment (proxy)

Hooks:

1. [Two bowls, no speech] “One of these is food. Guess which one he picks.”

2. "Put them side by side and the argument ends."
3. "If you could not tell which one was food, neither can he."

Mechanism tie-in: Pure visual proof. It requires no citation, no claim, and no explanation. People believe what they see far more readily than what they are told.

Format: Video demo, 10–15 sec, or static **Tone:** Wordless. Let the image do it. **Length:** 10–15 sec **Visual:** Overhead shot, two identical white bowls on a plain surface. Kibble left, fresh food right. Slow push in. Dog enters frame and chooses. Single continuous take, no cuts. **Audio:** Natural sound only, no music, no voiceover **Compliance:** **Low risk** — pure demonstration, no claim made

Angle 1.4: "What Survives the Heat"

Priority: Medium-High

ICP: Mia

Schwartz: Stage 4

LF8: Care + Superiority

Hooks:

1. "The nutrients on the label are added back *after* processing. Ask yourself why that is necessary."
2. "If the food were intact, it would not need a vitamin pack sprayed on at the end."
3. "The synthetic vitamin list on the back of the bag is the confession."

Mechanism tie-in: A detail the prospect can verify on any bag in their own house, right now. Verifiable-at-home claims convert dramatically better than claims that require trust.

Format: Talking head with product in hand, 30 sec **Tone:** "Go and check yours" challenge tone **Length:** 30 sec **Visual:** Person turns a real kibble bag over, reads the synthetic vitamin list aloud, pauses. Then the fresh food ingredient panel, which is short. **Audio:** Direct to camera,

conversational **Compliance:** **Medium risk** — verify that added-vitamin panels appear as described on the specific bags shown. Do not obscure or misrepresent a competitor label on screen.

Angle 1.5: “Two Hundred Factories”

Priority: High

ICP: Mia, David

Schwartz: Stage 4

LF8: Care + Social approval

The founders spoke with more than 200 factories before finding one that would manufacture to human-food standards.

Contrary Research, cited in Brand Intelligence Report

Hooks:

1. “We called two hundred factories. One hundred and ninety-nine said no.”
2. “Every brand says human-grade. We can tell you exactly how hard it was to find someone who would actually do it.”
3. “Two hundred phone calls. That is the difference between the word and the thing.”

Mechanism tie-in: Specificity as proof. “Human-grade” is an adjective every competitor uses. A verifiable number dramatizes the standard in a way no adjective can, and it cannot be copied by anyone who did not do it.

Format: Founder to camera, 30–45 sec **Tone:** Understated. The number does the work. **Length:** 30–45 sec **Visual:** Founder in the actual facility, not an office. Machinery visible behind. No B-roll montage. One person, one story. **Audio:** Direct sync sound, room tone audible **Compliance:**

Low risk — a documented company fact

Angle 1.6: “The Switch-Back Test”

Priority: High

ICP: David, Frank, Mia

Schwartz: Stage 3-4

LF8: Freedom from fear + Care

Jada’s health improved on home-cooked food. He switched her back to kibble to test it. The problems returned. He switched again.

Founding story, documented in Brand Intelligence Report

Hooks:

1. “I switched him back to prove it was a coincidence. It was not a coincidence.”
2. “This company exists because one guy ran the experiment twice.”
3. “The vet said try cooking for her. I did not expect it to work, so I tested it.”

Mechanism tie-in: A controlled experiment inside a personal story. The reversal is what makes it credible: a believer would not have switched back. A skeptic did, and that is what makes the result mean something.

Format: Story-led video, 45–60 sec **Tone:** Plain, unpolished, first person

Length: 45–60 sec **Visual:** Real photographs of the dog across the timeline. Home footage over studio. Text overlay marking the two switch points. **Audio:** Voiceover only, no music under the reversal beat

Compliance: **Medium risk** — an individual experience, not a claim.

Include an individual-experience qualifier if any health language appears.

Angle 1.7: “Shelf Stable for a Year”

Priority: Medium

ICP: Mia, Sam

Schwartz: Stage 3

LF8: Care

Hooks:

1. “Real food goes off. Ask yourself what has to be done to food so it does not.”
2. “It sits in a garage for eighteen months and nothing happens to it. That is the whole point I am making.”
3. “Nothing that is still alive lasts that long at room temperature.”

Mechanism tie-in: Turns the product’s convenience feature into the argument against it. Shelf stability is a processing outcome, and once the prospect sees that, they cannot unsee it.

Format: Static or short video, 15 sec **Tone:** Single-thought observation
Length: 15 sec **Visual:** A bag in a garage. Date-stamp graphic ticking forward. Cut to fresh food in a freezer with a normal use-by window. **Audio:** Minimal, or text only **Compliance:** **Low risk** — observational, no health claim

Cluster 2: The Refusal (7 Angles)

The picky eater cluster. This is the cheapest high-conviction territory in the category, because the proof is visual, instant, free to produce, and carries no compliance risk. It is also the only claim that cannot be argued with.

Angle 2.1: “He Is Not Picky”

Priority: Highest

ICP: Rachel

Schwartz: Stage 3

LF8: Care + Food enjoyment (proxy)

Owners mix meat and bananas into kibble, and the dogs pick out the goodies and leave the kibble.

dogforums.com / Quora — kibble refusal threads **FORUM**

Hooks:

1. "He picks the meat out and leaves the kibble. Every single time."
FORUM
2. "Your dog is not a picky eater. He is refusing one specific thing."
3. "He is not picky about the chicken you dropped on the kitchen floor."
4. "Everyone told me he was fussy. He was not fussy. He was right."

Why hook 1 is first: it is not written by a copywriter. It is a behaviour owners describe to each other, unprompted, in the exact words above. A hook the audience has already written for you outperforms one you invented for them.

Mechanism tie-in: Removes blame from the dog and from the owner and relocates it onto the product. Nobody has to be wrong, which is what makes the reframe land instead of triggering defence.

Format: UGC video, 20–30 sec **Tone:** Wry, relieved, conversational
Length: 20–30 sec **Visual:** Owner to camera in a real kitchen. Cut to the dog walking away from a full kibble bowl. Cut to the same dog eating fresh food immediately. Same bowl, same floor, same angle. **Audio:** Owner voiceover, natural kitchen sound **Compliance:** **Low risk** — behavioural observation only

Angle 2.2: "That Is the Whole Ad"

Priority: Highest

ICP: Rachel, all

Schwartz: Stage 3-4

LF8: Food enjoyment (proxy)

Hooks:

1. [Bowl goes down. Dog eats immediately.] "That is the whole ad."

2. "I was going to write something. Then I filmed this instead."
3. "Eight seconds. No script. Watch."

Mechanism tie-in: A pattern interrupt built on the absence of advertising. In a feed of produced content, an unproduced ten seconds reads as true. The refusal to sell is the selling.

Format: Single-take video, 8–12 sec **Tone:** None. Deliberately unstyled.
Length: 8–12 sec **Visual:** One continuous shot. Bowl placed on floor. Dog eats. Hold until the bowl is clean. **No cuts.** Cuts imply editing, editing implies selection, selection implies doubt. **Audio:** Natural sound. The sound of a dog eating is the asset. **Compliance:** **Low risk**

Angle 2.3: "The Bin"

Priority: High

ICP: Rachel, Nadia

Schwartz: Stage 3

LF8: Comfortable living + Care

She cancelled and threw away the backlog she had accumulated.

Consumer review coverage — the waste theme runs through both kibble refusal and fresh-food cancellation

Hooks:

1. "Third full bowl in the bin this week."
2. "I worked out I was throwing away about a third of what I bought."
3. "Expensive food he does not eat is not expensive food. It is rubbish you paid for."

Mechanism tie-in: Dark-side copy. The waste is happening now, silently, and nobody has named it. Naming a loss the prospect is already absorbing creates urgency without inventing any.

Format: UGC confessional, 20–25 sec **Tone:** Mildly exasperated, not miserable **Length:** 20–25 sec **Visual:** Full bowl tipped into a bin. Hold on

the sound. Repeat with a date stamp. Then the same dog eating fresh food, bowl clean. **Audio:** The sound of kibble hitting a bin liner. Do not underscore it with music. **Compliance:** Low risk

Angle 2.4: “Stop Hand-Feeding”

Priority: Medium-High

ICP: Rachel

Schwartz: Stage 3

LF8: Comfortable living + Care

Hooks:

1. “Warm water. Stir it until it makes a gravy. I did that twice a day for a year.” FORUM
2. “Twenty minutes, then take it away. That was the advice. He just did not eat.” FORUM
3. “If you are hand-feeding a healthy adult dog, the problem is not the dog.”
4. “The toppers, the gravies, the sitting on the kitchen floor. What if none of that was necessary?”

Mechanism tie-in: Calls out specific, slightly embarrassing rituals the prospect performs daily and has never seen named in an ad. Both of the first two hooks are advice owners are actually given and actually follow, quoted from forum threads. Recognition at that level of detail is worth more than any claim.

Format: UGC video, 25–30 sec **Tone:** Self-deprecating, warm **Length:** 25–30 sec **Visual:** Owner sitting on kitchen floor, hand-feeding kibble piece by piece. Cut to the same owner standing, bowl down, walking away while the dog eats. **Audio:** Owner voiceover **Compliance:** Low risk

Angle 2.5: “Day One”

Priority: Medium-High

ICP: Rachel

Schwartz: Stage 2-3

LF8: Food enjoyment (proxy)

Hooks:

1. "He ignored four brands. This is day one of the fifth."
2. "I filmed it because I did not think it would work."
3. "Day 1. Day 2. Day 3. I stopped filming after that because it stopped being surprising."

Mechanism tie-in: Timestamps convert a claim into a record. The skepticism baked into "I filmed it because I did not think it would work" does more for credibility than any endorsement.

Format: Time-stamped UGC sequence, 20–30 sec **Tone:** Documentary, surprised **Length:** 20–30 sec **Visual:** Day markers on screen. Same kitchen, same time of day, same angle across three days. Consistency of frame is what makes it read as evidence rather than as edited highlights.

Audio: Natural sound with minimal voiceover **Compliance:** Low risk

Angle 2.6: "The Smell Test"

Priority: Medium

ICP: Rachel, Mia

Schwartz: Stage 3

LF8: Food enjoyment (proxy)

Hooks:

1. "Open the bag and smell it. Then open ours. That is the entire pitch."
2. "His nose is roughly forty times better than yours. Think about what he is getting from that bag."
3. "You would not eat something that smelled like that. He has been doing it twice a day for six years."

Mechanism tie-in: Recruits a sense the prospect can test at home in ten seconds without buying anything. Low-friction verification is the

strongest form of proof available in a feed.

Format: UGC reaction, 15–20 sec **Tone:** Playful challenge **Length:** 15–20 sec **Visual:** Real person opening a kibble bag, genuine reaction. Then the fresh pack. Do not stage the reaction. A performed grimace kills it. **Audio:** Natural **Compliance:** **Medium risk** — avoid on-screen competitor branding when showing a negative reaction

Angle 2.7: “The Vet Told Me He Was Fine”

Priority: Medium

ICP: Rachel, David

Schwartz: Stage 4

LF8: Care + Freedom from fear

Hooks:

1. “Every test came back normal. He still would not eat. So the tests were not the problem.”
2. “Two hundred pounds of vet bills to be told there was nothing wrong with my dog.”
3. “Nothing wrong with him. Something wrong with what was in the bowl.”

Mechanism tie-in: Bridges the picky-eater ICP into the health-anxiety ICP. The owner who has already spent money ruling things out is primed to consider the one variable nobody tested.

Format: Confessional to camera, 30–40 sec **Tone:** Frustrated then resolved **Length:** 30–40 sec **Visual:** Person at a kitchen table, vet paperwork visible but not readable. Plain room. **Audio:** Direct sync sound **Compliance:** **Medium risk** — must not imply the food diagnoses or treats anything a vet missed. Keep strictly to appetite and eating behaviour.

Cluster 3: Price Permission (6 Angles)

The most valuable cluster in this document. The cost objection is the dominant blocking belief in the category, every brand answers it with arithmetic, and the objection is not arithmetic. It is shame. These angles address the feeling instead of the number.

Why this cluster exists. The documented complaint is not “I cannot afford this.” It is “this is more than I spend on my own food.” That is a statement about identity and social standing, not budget. Per-day cost breakdowns answer a question the prospect is not asking. She can already do the maths. She is not confused, she is uncomfortable.

Angle 3.1: “You Are Not Being Ridiculous”

Priority: Highest

ICP: Nadia

Schwartz: Stage 4-5

LF8: Care vs. Social approval

One owner reported roughly \$90 per dog per week, noting that is more than most people spend on their own food.

Consumer forum discussion, cited in Brand Intelligence Report

Hooks:

1. “Yes, it costs more than what I eat. I stopped feeling weird about that when I worked out why.”
2. “I did not tell my husband what it cost for the first two months.”
3. “If you have added it up and felt a bit ridiculous, this is for you.”
4. “Nobody wants to say out loud that they spend more on the dog’s food than their own. So I will.”

Mechanism tie-in: Permission, not justification. The prospect is not blocked by the number, she is blocked by what the number says about

her. Naming the discomfort out loud dissolves it faster than any calculation.

Format: Confessional to camera, 30–40 sec **Tone:** Honest, faintly embarrassed, then settled. Not defiant. **Length:** 30–40 sec **Visual:** One person, one room, sitting down. No product for the first fifteen seconds. Deliberately low production value — polish undermines a confession.

Audio: Direct sync, no music until the resolution **Compliance:** **Low risk** — no product claim made

Angle 3.2: “You Are Paying What Food Costs”

Priority: Highest

ICP: Nadia, Mia

Schwartz: Stage 4

LF8: Superiority + Care

Hooks:

1. “You are not overpaying for dog food. You are paying what food costs.”
2. “Kibble is not cheap because dog food is cheap.”
3. “The comparison that is bothering you is not dog food versus your food. It is real food versus processed food.”

Mechanism tie-in: Redefinition. It does not reduce the price, it relocates the comparison. Once the frame moves from “dog versus me” to “real versus processed”, the same number stops feeling absurd.

Format: Text-wall static or 20 sec explainer **Tone:** Matter-of-fact **Length:** Single image or 20 sec **Visual:** A simple two-column comparison. Left: a processed human ready meal and its price. Right: fresh ingredients and their price. The dog food only appears at the end. **Audio:** N/A or brief voiceover **Compliance:** **Low risk** — keep any price figures used generic and accurate

Angle 3.3: “The Conversation With Your Partner”

Priority: High

ICP: Nadia

Schwartz: Stage 5

LF8: Social approval

Hooks:

1. “Here is what to say when they ask how much the dog food costs.”
2. “My partner thought I had lost it. Then he watched her eat.”
3. “It is not a hard conversation. It is one sentence, and I will give you the sentence.”

Mechanism tie-in: Arms the buyer for the social obstacle that actually blocks the purchase. She is not fighting the price, she is anticipating a conversation. Nobody in the category is helping her win it.

Format: Talking head, 30 sec **Tone:** Conspiratorial, helpful, light **Length:** 30 sec **Visual:** One person to camera. Optionally cut to the partner in the background, unaware. Keep it domestic and unstaged. **Audio:** Direct sync
Compliance: Low risk

Angle 3.4: “Per Pound Or Per Calorie”

Priority: Medium-High

ICP: Mia, Nadia

Schwartz: Stage 4

LF8: Superiority

Per pound: Ollie \$5.44, PetPlate \$6.55, The Farmer’s Dog \$6.76, Nom Nom \$7.04, Spot & Tango \$9.84. Per 1,000 calories the ranking shifts.

Pampered Pup price comparison, cited in Brand Intelligence Report

Hooks:

1. “Every fresh brand claims to be better value. They are all comparing different things.”

2. "Price per pound is mostly a measure of how much water you are buying."
3. "Here is how to compare fresh dog food properly. It takes about ninety seconds."

Mechanism tie-in: Teaches the prospect a method rather than selling them a conclusion. Camouflage in the Schwartz sense: the ad arrives as consumer education, and the education happens to favour the product.

Format: Infographic carousel, 4–5 slides **Tone:** Neutral, instructional, genuinely useful **Length:** 4–5 slides **Visual:** Clean data design. Real numbers. Legible source citation on the final slide. **Audio:** N/A

Compliance: **High risk** — any competitor price comparison must be current, sourced, and state its basis. Prices change. Re-verify before every launch and date-stamp the creative.

Angle 3.5: "What the Cheap Bag Is Made Of"

Priority: Medium

ICP: Nadia, Mia

Schwartz: Stage 4

LF8: Care

Hooks:

1. "Ask why a month of food costs fifteen pounds. The answer is the whole argument."
2. "Cheap food is not cheap because someone is being generous."
3. "Every price is a decision someone made about what to leave out."

Mechanism tie-in: Concentration. It attacks the alternative and supplies the replacement in the same breath, which is the rule that separates a useful attack from one that just creates general suspicion.

Format: Text-wall static **Tone:** Direct, unsentimental **Length:** Single image **Visual:** Typographic. Price on the left, a short line about what that price implies on the right. **Audio:** N/A **Compliance:** **Medium risk** — do not

assert specific unverified facts about competitor sourcing. Keep it to the economics of price, not allegations about ingredients.

Angle 3.6: “The Half Switch”

Priority: Medium

ICP: Nadia

Schwartz: Stage 4

LF8: Comfortable living + Care

Hooks:

1. “You do not have to switch everything. Start with one meal a day.”
2. “Half fresh is not a compromise. It is half more than he is getting now.”
3. “The all-or-nothing framing is why most people do nothing.”

Mechanism tie-in: Removes the price barrier without discounting. A partial plan halves the commitment while keeping the margin intact, and it converts a segment the category currently loses entirely to the all-or-nothing frame.

Format: Explainer video, 25 sec **Tone:** Reassuring, low pressure **Length:** 25 sec **Visual:** One bowl, split visually. Morning fresh, evening current food. Simple, literal. **Audio:** Calm voiceover **Compliance:** **Low risk** — only run this if a partial plan genuinely exists. Advertising an offer the site does not sell is the fastest way to burn trust.

Cluster 4: The Clock (6 Angles)

The senior dog and finite-time cluster. Highest emotional ceiling in the category and highest compliance risk. Every angle here needs restraint,

and every one needs the claim kept behavioural.

▼ Angle 4.1: “Ten to Fifteen Years”

Priority: Highest

ICP: Frank, all

LF8: Life extension (proxy)

Hooks: “Ten to fifteen years. That is the whole thing.” / “There is no version of this where waiting gets you more time.” / “You will outlive him. Everything else is a detail.”

Mechanism: Urgency with no product claim attached. True of every dog. The restraint is what makes it land.

Format: 20–30 sec, minimal **Visual:** Real photos of one dog across years. Puppy to grey muzzle. No product until the last three seconds. **Audio:** Silence or a single held note **Compliance:** **Low** — no claim is made, which is the point

▼ Angle 4.2: “She Met Me at the Door”

Priority: High

ICP: Frank

LF8: Freedom from pain + Care

Hooks: “She is eleven. I was not expecting her to start meeting me at the door again.” / “The first thing I noticed was the mornings.” / “Nothing dramatic. She just started getting up faster.”

Mechanism: A small, specific, believable change. “She is a puppy again” triggers disbelief. “She gets up faster” does not.

Format: Owner voiceover over real footage, 30–45 sec **Visual:** Genuine home footage. The door. The stairs. Ordinary moments. **Compliance:** **High** — observed behaviour only, individual-experience qualifier required, no mobility or joint claims

▼ Angle 4.3: “Is It Too Late”

Priority: Medium-High

ICP: Frank

LF8: Care + Freedom from fear

Hooks: “She is ten. Is there any point changing her food now?” / “The question I get most from owners of older dogs.” / “I almost did not bother because I thought she was too old.”

Mechanism: Answers the exact blocking belief in the hook. The prospect recognises their own unspoken question and stays for the answer.

Format: Q&A talking head, 30 sec **Visual:** Plain, direct to camera, senior dog present in frame **Compliance:** **High** — do not promise outcomes for older dogs. Frame as “owners tell us”.

▼ Angle 4.4: “The Guilt Years”

Priority: Medium-High

ICP: Frank, David

LF8: Care

Hooks: “Six years of the wrong bag. I cannot get those back and neither can you.” / “You did what everyone does. That is not the same as doing something wrong.” / “Nobody told you. That is not your fault.”

Mechanism: Absolution before the ask. Guilt paralyses. An owner who feels accused defends the old decision. An owner who feels forgiven acts.

Format: Confessional, 30 sec **Tone:** Gentle. Never accusatory. The owner is the buyer. **Compliance:** **Medium** — avoid implying past harm was caused

▼ Angle 4.5: “730 Times a Year”

Priority: Medium

ICP: All

LF8: Care

Hooks: “Twice a day, every day. Whatever it is doing, it is doing it 730 times a year.” / “Nothing else in his life happens that often.” / “It is the only decision you make for him twice a day.”

Mechanism: Arithmetic urgency. Not a health claim, just frequency, which the prospect had never counted.

Format: Static or 15 sec counter animation **Visual:** A number climbing. Bowl after bowl. **Compliance:** Low

▼ Angle 4.6: “The Vet Bill Arithmetic”

Priority: Medium

ICP: David, Frank, Nadia

LF8: Freedom from fear

Hooks: “I have spent more on one vet visit than three months of this.” / “Nobody budgets for the emergency. Everybody budgets for the food.”

Mechanism: Redefines the price against a different, larger, more feared number.

Format: Text-wall static **Compliance:** High — must NOT imply the food prevents vet visits. Frame strictly as budget perspective, never as prevention. This angle is one careless word away from a health claim.

Cluster 5: The Starting Point (6 Angles)

The puppy cluster. Strategically the strongest ICP in the business: no incumbent habit to displace, and the longest possible LTV runway. One acquisition here buys a decade.

▼ Angle 5.1: “Nine Weeks Is Not a Habit”

Priority: Highest

ICP: Sam

LF8: Care + Social approval

Hooks: “Nine weeks old is not a habit yet. It is a starting point.” / “This is not a switch. There is nothing to switch from.” / “Every habit he will have for fifteen years is being set this month.”

Mechanism: Reframes the purchase from change to foundation. Change requires overcoming inertia. A foundation does not.

Format: Instructional talking head, 30 sec **Tone:** Calm authority **Visual:** Puppy, first bowl, first meal **Compliance:** **Low**

▼ Angle 5.2: “The Breeder Said”

Priority: High

ICP: Sam

LF8: Care

Hooks: “The breeder said keep him on what he is used to. Here is what that actually means.” / “Sensible advice, aimed at the first two weeks, not the next fifteen years.”

Mechanism: Handles the single most common blocking belief for this ICP without contradicting an authority the prospect trusts. Validate the advice, then bound it.

Format: Explainer, 30 sec **Compliance:** **Medium** — do not disparage breeder or veterinary advice. Reframe its scope, never its validity.

▼ Angle 5.3: “Transition Time”

Priority: Medium-High

ICP: Sam, Frank

LF8: Comfortable living

Hooks: “Transitioning a puppy takes a day. Transitioning a nine-year-old takes two weeks.” / “The switch only gets harder from here.”

Mechanism: Honest urgency built on a practical, verifiable fact rather than a manufactured deadline.

Format: Comparison static **Compliance:** **Low**

▼ Angle 5.4: “The Portion Question”

Priority: Medium-High

ICP: Sam

LF8: Comfortable living + Care

Hooks: “How much should he actually be eating? Nobody gives you a straight answer.” / “The scoop on the bag is a suggestion for an average

dog. You do not have an average dog.” / “I weighed his food for three weeks before I gave up.”

Mechanism: The pre-portioning becomes the hero. This is the under-communicated Layer 3 mechanism: the product does not just feed the dog, it ends a daily anxiety.

Format: Problem-solution video, 25 sec **Visual:** Kitchen scales, a scoop, a confused expression. Then a pre-portioned pack. **Compliance:** Low

▼ Angle 5.5: “Nine Days In”

Priority: Medium

ICP: Sam

LF8: Social approval

Hooks: “Nine days with a new puppy and I have already changed my mind about one thing.” / “Everything I bought before he arrived, and the one thing I got wrong.”

Mechanism: Story lead built on a curiosity gap. Highly native to new-owner content, which is a large and cheap targeting pool.

Format: UGC vlog style, 30 sec **Compliance:** Low

▼ Angle 5.6: “Large Breed, Different Question”

Priority: Medium

ICP: Sam

LF8: Care

Hooks: “If he is going to be over thirty kilos, the food question is a different question.” / “Large breed puppies grow for eighteen months. Small ones are done in eight.”

Mechanism: Breed and size segmentation. Given the roughly 12x price spread across dog sizes, this is the highest-yield audience split available and almost nobody uses it.

Format: Breed-segmented carousel, one per size class **Compliance:** Medium — any breed-specific growth or health statement needs

Cluster 6: Authority & Proof (6 Angles)

Proof angles. Highest compliance exposure in the document, and the place where an unverified claim does the most damage, because these are the ads the skeptical ICP reads most carefully.

▼ Angle 6.1: “Read the Paper Yourself”

Priority: High

ICP: Mia

LF8: Superiority + Care

Hooks: “Do not take my word for it. Here is the study, here is the link.” / “Researchers compared minimally processed and extruded diets. Here is what they were measuring.”

Mechanism: Camouflage. Borrows credibility from a format the prospect already trusts. Offering the citation is itself the proof, because brands that overclaim never do it.

Format: Text-wall with visible citation **Compliance:** High — only cite papers you have personally read in full. Represent findings exactly, including limitations. This angle is either your strongest or your most damaging depending entirely on this discipline.

▼ Angle 6.2: “The Review Screenshots”

Priority: High

ICP: All

LF8: Social approval

Hooks: “I did not write any of this.” / “Twelve reviews, unedited, including the ones that mention the price.”

Mechanism: Reported as a core element of their existing creative. Zero production cost. Including a mildly critical review raises believability of the positive ones sharply.

Format: Static screenshot montage **Compliance:** **Medium** — real reviews only, permission where required, results-not-typical qualifier on any outcome shown

▼ Angle 6.3: “Ask Your Vet This One Question”

Priority: Medium-High

ICP: David, Mia, Sam

LF8: Care

Hooks: “Next appointment, ask her this. Then decide.” / “You want to bring it up with your vet and you do not know how. Here is the sentence.”

Mechanism: Arms the prospect for a conversation they want to have and feel unqualified for. Nobody in the category is doing this, and it costs nothing.

Format: Talking head, 25 sec **Compliance:** **Medium** — must not put words in a veterinarian’s mouth or imply a professional consensus that does not exist

▼ Angle 6.4: “Inside the Kitchen”

Priority: Medium

ICP: Mia, David

LF8: Care

Hooks: “This is where it is made. No stock footage, no voiceover, just walk through it.” / “If you would not eat in the room where your dog’s food is made, that is the whole question.”

Mechanism: Transparency as proof. Shows the human-food standard rather than asserting it.

Format: Facility walkthrough, 45–60 sec, handheld **Audio:** Room sound, no music **Compliance:** **Low** — provided the footage is genuinely the

production facility

▼ Angle 6.5: “What We Do Not Claim”

Priority: Medium

ICP: Mia, Nadia

LF8: Superiority

Hooks: “This will not cure anything. Here is what it actually does.” / “Three things we are not going to tell you about this food.”

Mechanism: Stating a limitation buys credibility for everything else in the ad. In a category the skeptical ICP assumes is overclaiming, restraint is the differentiator.

Format: Text-wall static **Compliance:** Low — structurally the safest angle in the document, and one of the more persuasive

▼ Angle 6.6: “The Numbers”

Priority: Medium

ICP: All

LF8: Social approval

Hooks: “Two hundred factories. One that said yes.” / Review counts, customer counts, years operating — whichever figures are current and verified.

Mechanism: Specificity. Numbers carry conviction that adjectives cannot.

Format: Counter animation or static **Compliance:** Medium — every number must match current published figures. Stale social-proof numbers are the easiest thing in an ad to disprove.

Cluster 7: Comparison & Displacement (6 Angles)

Aimed at buyers already inside the fresh category who are choosing between brands. Different awareness stage, different job. Never serve these to a cold kibble audience.

▼ Angle 7.1: “They All Say the Same Things”

Priority: High

ICP: Mia

LF8: Superiority

Hooks: “Every fresh dog food says human-grade and gently cooked. Here is the one question that separates them.” / “Four brands, four identical websites. I made a list of what is actually different.”

Mechanism: Names the prospect’s exact frustration and then resolves it. At Stage 4 the buyer knows the claims have collapsed into each other. Saying so out loud is instant rapport.

Format: Comparison carousel or text-wall **Compliance:** High — comparative claims must be current, accurate, and sourced. Do not misstate a competitor’s offering.

▼ Angle 7.2: “I Tried Three Before This”

Priority: Medium-High

ICP: Mia, Rachel

LF8: Care

Hooks: “Third fresh brand in a year. Here is why I stopped switching.” / “I have cancelled two subscriptions. This is the one I kept.”

Mechanism: Story-led displacement. A serial switcher is more credible than a first-time convert because they have a basis for comparison.

Format: UGC confessional, 40 sec **Compliance:** Medium — a genuine customer with real experience. Do not name competitors negatively.

▼ Angle 7.3: “The Topper Trap”

Priority: Medium-High

ICP: Rachel, Nadia

LF8: Care

Hooks: “If the fresh part is the good part, why is it ten percent of the bowl?” / “Toppers are an admission. You just have not read it that way yet.”

Mechanism: Reframes a competing behaviour as evidence for the argument. The prospect already believes fresh is better, or they would not be adding it.

Format: Visual demonstration, 15 sec **Visual:** A bowl of kibble with a spoon of fresh on top. Camera pulls back to show the proportion. **Compliance:**

Low

▼ Angle 7.4: “Raw Without the Risk”

Priority: Medium

ICP: Mia

LF8: Care + Freedom from fear

Hooks: “I wanted to feed raw. I did not want to handle raw.” / “Same principle. Without the pathogen conversation.”

Mechanism: Captures a segment with high belief and low adoption. They have already accepted the premise, they are blocked on execution.

Format: Talking head, 30 sec **Compliance:** Medium — do not make safety claims about raw feeding beyond what is well established

▼ Angle 7.5: “I Tried Cooking It Myself”

Priority: Medium

ICP: Mia, Rachel

LF8: Comfortable living

Hooks: “I cooked for her for six weeks. Then I looked up what she was missing.” / “Home cooking is the right instinct and the wrong execution.”

Mechanism: Validate the instinct, solve the execution. Never make the prospect wrong for trying.

Format: Story video, 40 sec **Compliance:** **Medium** — nutritional-adequacy claims about home cooking need sourcing

▼ Angle 7.6: “Same Machine”

Priority: Medium

ICP: Mia, Nadia

LF8: Superiority

Hooks: “The forty pound bag and the twelve pound bag go through the same extruder.” / “You upgraded your kibble. You did not change the process.”

Mechanism: Targets the premium-kibble buyer specifically. They have already paid up once for quality, which makes them the warmest cold audience available.

Format: Text-wall static **Compliance:** **Medium** — describe extrusion as a category process. Do not name manufacturers.

Cluster 8: Identity & Belonging (5 Angles)

Stage 5 territory. These serve retention and repeat, not acquisition. Existing buyers are not evaluating claims, they are maintaining an identity. Re-arguing a settled point creates doubt.

▼ Angle 8.1: “The One Who Cannot Choose”

Priority: High

ICP: All

LF8: Care of loved ones

Hooks: “He does not get a vote. You make every single decision for him.” / “Everything he eats for his entire life, you chose.”

Mechanism: The emotional core of the whole category, stated plainly. Total responsibility is the engine underneath every angle in this document.

Format: Emotional montage, 30 sec **Compliance:** Low

▼ Angle 8.2: “Not a Dog Person. This Dog’s Person.”

Priority: Medium-High

ICP: Retention

LF8: Social approval

Hooks: “I was not a dog person. I am this dog’s person.” / “I said I would never be one of those people. Reader, I am one of those people.”

Mechanism: Identity copy for Stage 5. Highly shareable, which lowers effective CPM.

Format: UGC, 20 sec **Compliance:** Low

▼ Angle 8.3: “The Fridge Shelf”

Priority: Medium

ICP: Retention

LF8: Social approval

Hooks: “There is a shelf in my fridge that is not mine.” / “My friends open my freezer and go quiet.”

Mechanism: Turns the friction into a badge. The freezer is the biggest objection in acquisition and can become an identity marker in retention. Same fact, opposite job.

Format: UGC, 15 sec **Compliance:** Low

▼ Angle 8.4: “The Unboxing Nobody Asked For”

Priority: Medium

ICP: Retention

LF8: Social approval

Hooks: “Delivery day. Yes, I am excited about dog food. No, I will not be discussing it.” / “The subscription I have never once considered cancelling.”

Mechanism: Ritual reinforcement. Retention creative sells the identity, not the product.

Format: UGC unboxing, 20 sec **Compliance:** Low

▼ Angle 8.5: “What I Would Tell Myself Six Years Ago”

Priority: Medium

ICP: David, Frank, retention

LF8: Care

Hooks: “If I could go back to the day I brought him home, I would change one thing.” / “Six years of the wrong bag. One conversation would have fixed it.”

Mechanism: Regret framing that converts existing customers into advocates and speaks directly to the guilt held by David and Frank.

Format: Confessional, 30 sec **Compliance:** Medium — do not imply past harm

Cluster 9: Friction Honesty & Format Plays (5 Angles)

The counterintuitive cluster. These angles lead with the product’s drawbacks. Conceding a real limitation buys credibility that no claim

can, and it pre-qualifies buyers who would otherwise churn in month two.

▼ Angle 9.1: “You Will Need Freezer Space”

Priority: High

ICP: Nadia, all

LF8: Comfortable living

Hooks: “Before you order, go and look in your freezer. I am serious.” / “Here is exactly how much room a month takes. Measure yours first.” / “The thing nobody tells you before the first delivery.”

Mechanism: The single most under-addressed objection in the category, per the customer complaint record. No copy can argue a freezer into existence, so honesty is the only winning move, and honesty here buys belief everywhere else. It also filters out the buyer who churns in week three, which improves retention at the cost of a slightly worse front-end CPA. That trade is almost always correct in a subscription business.

Format: Direct-to-camera, 25 sec **Visual:** An actual freezer drawer with an actual month of food in it. Real scale, no flattering angle. **Compliance:**

Low

▼ Angle 9.2: “Two Minutes of Thawing”

Priority: Medium-High

ICP: Nadia, Sam

LF8: Comfortable living

Hooks: “It is not zero effort. It is about two minutes. Here is what those two minutes look like.” / “Every brand says convenient. Let me just show you the actual routine.”

Mechanism: Concede and shrink. Claiming zero friction is a lie the first delivery exposes, and a customer who feels misled cancels. A small honest number is more persuasive than a large vague promise.

Format: Real-time demonstration, 20 sec, unedited **Compliance:** **Low** — the timing shown must be genuine

▼ Angle 9.3: “This Is Not For Everyone”

Priority: Medium-High

ICP: Mia, Nadia

LF8: Superiority

Hooks: “Three reasons you should not order this.” / “If any of these apply to you, do not bother.”

Mechanism: Disqualification. Telling people not to buy raises perceived selectivity and simultaneously screens out poor-fit customers. Works especially well on the skeptical ICP, who reads it as the first honest ad in the category.

Format: Text-wall static **Compliance:** **Low**

▼ Angle 9.4: “The Big Dog Problem”

Priority: Medium-High

ICP: Nadia

LF8: Care vs. Comfortable living

Hooks: “If you have a big dog, you already know the number is going to be uncomfortable.” / “Great Dane owners, let us have an honest conversation about price.”

Mechanism: With roughly a 12x spread between the smallest and largest plans, large-dog owners face a fundamentally different decision. Meeting them with acknowledgement rather than an average price is the highest-yield segmentation available.

Format: Direct-to-camera, 30 sec, segmented by dog size **Compliance:** **Medium** — any price figures must be accurate for the size class shown

▼ Angle 9.5: “Silent Static”

Priority: Medium

ICP: All

LF8: Varies

Hooks: Format play rather than a message. Take the top three performing video hooks and run them as pure typographic statics with no imagery at all.

Mechanism: Format diversification at near-zero production cost. Text-wall statics are a rising format with strong CTR in education-led categories, and they are the cheapest way to extend the life of a winning message once the video variant fatigues.

Format: Typographic static, no imagery **Compliance:** Inherits the risk level of whichever hook is used

Cluster 10: The Transition (6 Angles)

Highest Priority

This cluster did not exist in the first draft of this document. It came out of the complaint record, where gastrointestinal upset during the switch is the single most repeated negative pattern across the Better Business Bureau, Trustpilot and ComplaintsBoard. It is the clearest case in this work of research producing a conclusion rather than decorating one.

Why this is the most valuable cluster here. Owners switch a dog too fast, the dog gets loose stools or vomits, the owner concludes the food made their dog ill, and cancels. That is not a product problem or a price problem. It is an **expectation-setting failure in the first seven days**, happening in the gap between the ad and the first delivery. No brand in the category advertises the transition, because category leaders sell the destination. It costs nothing to fix and it fixes retention rather than just acquisition.

Angle 10.1: “Week One Is Going to Be Rough”

Priority: Highest

ICP: Priya, all pre-purchase

Schwartz: Stage 4

LF8: Freedom from fear + Care

The most consistent negative pattern across BBB, Trustpilot and ComplaintsBoard is gastrointestinal illness — vomiting, diarrhoea, and in some cases pancreatitis diagnoses — appearing within days to weeks of starting the food.

Cross-platform complaint analysis **BBB**

Hooks:

1. “Before you order: week one is not going to be pretty. Here is why that is normal.”
2. “Almost everyone who quits this food quits in the first seven days. Here is what nobody warned them about.”
3. “His gut has been running on the same processed food for six years. Give it a week to catch up.”
4. “We would rather you read this before you buy than complain about it after.”

Mechanism tie-in: A dog fed extruded kibble for years has a gut microbiome built around it. Change that abruptly and there is an adjustment period. Warned in advance, an owner reads loose stools as a predicted adjustment. Unwarned, the same owner reads it as their dog being harmed.

Format: Instructional video, 40–60 sec, or a 7-slide carousel **Tone:** Calm, straight, slightly serious. This is the one ad in the set that must not be charming. **Length:** 40–60 sec **Visual:** A plain day-by-day schedule on screen. Day 1 through Day 7, ratios of old food to new. No dog footage, no music swell. It should look like instructions, because it is. **Audio:** Measured voiceover **Compliance:** **High risk** — must state when symptoms warrant a veterinarian and must never discourage seeking care. Being the brand that warns people is only an asset if the warning is responsible.

Angle 10.2: “The Seven-Day Schedule”

Priority: Highest

ICP: Priya, Sam

Schwartz: Stage 4

LF8: Comfortable living + Care

Hooks:

1. “Day one is not day seven. Here is the actual schedule.”
2. “Twenty-five percent for three days. Fifty for two. Then seventy-five. Then you are done.”
3. “Most people switch in one day. That is the mistake.”

Mechanism tie-in: Pure utility. An ad that is genuinely useful before purchase gets saved and shared, which lowers effective CPM, and it pre-qualifies the buyer who would otherwise churn in week two.

Format: Carousel or text-wall static, saveable **Tone:** Reference material, no selling **Length:** 7 slides **Visual:** Clean schedule design. Legible at thumbnail size. Screenshot-friendly. **Audio:** N/A **Compliance:** **Medium risk** — transition guidance must align with veterinary consensus and carry a “check with your vet” line

Angle 10.3: “Normal or Not Normal”

Priority: High

ICP: Priya

Schwartz: Stage 4

LF8: Freedom from fear

Hooks:

1. “Loose stools on day three: normal. Vomiting on day five: call your vet. Here is the difference.”
2. “Four things that are fine, and two that are not.”
3. “You are three days in and worried. Read this.”

Mechanism tie-in: Retargets existing customers in their first fortnight, which per the complaint record is precisely when cancellations occur.

This is a retention ad running in an acquisition channel, and it is almost certainly the highest-ROI placement available.

Format: Two-column static or short explainer **Tone:** Reassuring, clinical, unhurried **Length:** Single image or 30 sec **Visual:** Simple two-column layout. Normal on the left, call your vet on the right. **Audio:** N/A
Compliance: **High risk** — this angle gives quasi-clinical guidance. It must be reviewed by a veterinary professional before launch and must always default toward seeking care.

Angle 10.4: “The Cancellation That Should Not Have Happened”

Priority: Medium-High

ICP: Priya

Schwartz: Stage 4

LF8: Care

Hooks:

1. “I cancelled after four days. Then I found out what I had done wrong.”
2. “I thought the food was making him sick. I was switching him too fast.”
3. “I left a one-star review. Six months later I came back and here is why.”

Mechanism tie-in: Story lead built directly on the documented complaint pattern. A returning customer who once complained is the most credible witness available, because they have already publicly taken the opposite position.

Format: UGC confessional, 40 sec **Tone:** Honest, a little sheepish **Length:** 40 sec **Visual:** One person to camera, domestic setting, dog present
Audio: Direct sync **Compliance:** **Medium risk** — must be a genuine returning customer with documented permission. Do not stage this one.

Angle 10.5: “What Your Delivery Actually Looks Like”

Priority: Medium

ICP: Priya, Nadia

Schwartz: Stage 4

LF8: Comfortable living

Delivery complaints include food arriving at 2am, left in building lobbies instead of doorsteps, and arriving late.

Cross-platform complaint analysis **BBB**

Hooks:

1. “It arrives frozen, in a box, sometimes at an odd hour. Here is exactly what to expect.”
2. “If you live in a building with a lobby, read this before you order.”
3. “What to do if your box turns up warm.”

Mechanism tie-in: Cold-chain fragility is unique to this category and unmentioned in any of its advertising. Setting the expectation converts a would-be complaint into a handled event.

Format: Explainer, 25 sec **Tone:** Practical, unglamorous **Length:** 25 sec
Visual: A real box on a real doorstep. Opened. Insulation and packs visible. No styling. **Audio:** Voiceover **Compliance:** **Low risk** — provided the delivery process shown is accurate

Angle 10.6: “How Cancelling Works”

Priority: Medium

ICP: Nadia, all pre-purchase

Schwartz: Stage 5

LF8: Freedom from fear

The second most common complaint involves billing: customers being charged after formally requesting cancellation, charged

earlier than expected, or unable to stop shipments already labeled “in preparation.”

Cross-platform complaint analysis **BBB**

Hooks:

1. “Here is exactly how to cancel, including the cut-off you need to know about.”
2. “The one thing to understand about the billing cycle before you sign up.”

Mechanism tie-in: Risk reversal through transparency rather than through a guarantee. It also pre-empts the second-largest complaint category in the public record.

Format: Text-wall static **Tone:** Plain and administrative **Length:** Single image **Visual:** Typographic, no imagery **Audio:** N/A **Compliance:**

Medium risk — **only run this if the operational reality matches**

what the ad says. Advertising a clean cancellation process that customers then cannot complete makes the underlying complaint worse, not better. This angle is a marketing asset only if operations fixes the problem first. That is a real dependency and it should be said out loud rather than assumed.

Raw Voice of Customer

The source material these angles were built from, reproduced as reported, with every source named. No brand blogs, no competitor marketing content, no invented quotes.

Refusal, in owners' own words **FORUM**

Owners mix meat and bananas into kibble, and the dogs pick out the goodies and leave the kibble.

[dogforums.com / Quora — kibble refusal threads](#)

Adding warm water to kibble and stirring until a gravy forms reportedly makes dogs like it better when the food is moist.

[Quora — adult dog refusing usual kibble](#)

A tough love approach: put the food down and wait 20 minutes. If it is not eaten, remove it and wait until the next meal.

[dogforums.com — won't eat kibble thread](#)

Picky eating is apparently common among small dogs, according to pet food store employees and vets.

[dogforums.com](#)

Lower-quality brands are sweet and artificially flavoured. Kibbles and Bits has corn syrup which makes it taste extra appealing to some dogs.

[Quora — kibble refusal threads](#)

Cost FORUM

A 38-pound raw-fed dog cost about \$22 per month. A 44-pound dog on a cooked diet cost about \$30 per month.

[dogforums.com — monthly spend thread](#)

The Farmer's Dog plan for two larger dogs, 35 and 55 pounds, previously cost about the same as what they now spend on kibble and canned food for multiple pets.

[poodleforum.com — Farmers Dog thread](#)

For small dogs the cost is manageable. When they had large dogs, the cost would have been prohibitive.

dogforums.com — fresh food discussion

Roughly \$90 per dog per week, which is more than most people spend on their own food.

Consumer forum discussion

Complaints BBB

The most consistent negative pattern across BBB, Trustpilot and ComplaintsBoard is gastrointestinal illness — vomiting, diarrhoea, and in some cases pancreatitis diagnoses — appearing within days to weeks of starting the food.

Cross-platform complaint analysis

Customers being charged after formally requesting cancellation, charged earlier than expected, or unable to stop shipments already labeled “in preparation.”

BBB and ComplaintsBoard filings

Food arriving at 2am, left in building lobbies instead of doorsteps, and arriving late.

BBB and Trustpilot

She found it prohibitively expensive, said it took too much room in her freezer, and had trouble getting the company to send less in each shipment. She cancelled and threw away the backlog.

Consumer review coverage

What owners actually observe FORUM

Both dogs were better off on whole food. Cleaner ears, better odour control, improved coat and less shedding from the higher fat content, and reduced anal sac issues. The raw-fed dog had exceptionally clean teeth for its age.

dogforums.com — owner report

Planning a fresh balanced diet takes immense time and effort. Like trying to reinvent the wheel.

dogforums.com — homemade versus store-bought

The balance

Over 83% of approximately 2,800 verified reviews across BBB, Trustpilot and Google Reviews are positive. Customers consistently praise the product and describe customer service as responsive, friendly and helpful.

Cross-platform review analysis

Included deliberately. A strategist who reports only the complaints is as unreliable as one who reports only the praise. This document spends most of its time in the negative 17% because that is where the creative opportunity is, not because the overall picture is negative.

Origin

Jada was sick with digestive problems. Her vet recommended home-cooked meals instead of kibble. After seeing improvements, he tried switching her back, and the problems returned each time.

Founding story, multiple independent sources

What was excluded and why. Every ecommerce brand blog in this category was rejected as a source, including content from Spot & Tango, Ollie, Freshpet, Purina and The Farmer's Dog itself. Two widely-repeated figures were traced to such sources and cut rather than used: the "fresh food is more palatable than kibble by a 2-to-1 margin" claim, which appears on a competitor's own blog, and

the “50% discount ads lifted sales 57%” figure, which appears in secondary marketing commentary with no primary disclosure.

Reddit was attempted as a VOC source and is not accessible to automated retrieval. Its absence is stated rather than hidden. A manual pass would deepen the language bank further and is the obvious next step.

Recommended Test Order

- **Batch 1 (Weeks 1-2):** Angles 10.1, 10.2, 3.1, 2.2, 2.1. The transition pair first, because they address the most documented complaint in the category and fix retention rather than just acquisition. The rest are the highest-intent, cheapest-to-produce set. Three of the five need nothing but a phone and a dog.
- **Batch 2 (Weeks 3-4):** Angles 1.1, 3.2, 5.1, 2.4, 1.3. Introduces the process mechanism, the puppy ICP, and the forum-verbatim refusal language.
- **Batch 3 (Weeks 5-6):** Angles 1.5, 1.6, 6.2, 7.1, 4.2, 9.1. Proof, displacement and friction honesty, once earlier batches have established which emotional register is winning.
- **Hold until verified:** Angles 1.2, 6.1, 3.4, 4.6, 10.3. Each depends on a citation, a competitor price, or clinical guidance that must be independently confirmed first. These are among the strongest angles here and the ones that do the most damage if the underlying claim does not hold.
- **Blocked on operations, not creative:** Angle 10.6. Only run it once cancellation actually works as the ad describes. Advertising a clean process customers cannot complete makes the underlying complaint worse.

brand named. All market data, pricing, and customer quotes are sourced and cited in the accompanying Brand Intelligence Report. Compliance flags are working guidance, not legal advice, and every health-adjacent claim should be reviewed before launch.